

Moving upwards

AMD announces profits of \$257 million in the first quarter of this year

Infinity Ward Respawns

Ex-Infinity Ward members create new Respawn Entertainment

the status bar at the bottom of the display. This shows you the current position like any other player but it also displays the amount of cached video while streaming online content. It's a pity performance in the menu deteriorates so much.

Iomega ScreenPlay Director

The Iomega ScreenPlay Director HD player is a somewhat bulky media player in comparison to some of the other products that we received. It's a product that comes with a glossy finished plastic case. It has an internal one terabyte desktop drive which makes the product a little heavy but sturdy. Powering on the device takes ages – something we discovered when we plugged it in for the first time. It's likely it's reading all the data on the drive.

The remote control is large and almost identical to the Seagate FreeAgent Theater+'s remote.

In terms of video quality, the colours appear somewhat paler and washed out if compared to the other players. Detail was more or less the same as the others. One of the specialties of the remote are the dedicated buttons for music, video and audio, which let you quickly jump between the types of content without going back to the start screen. Switching between menus is very slow. BitTorrent is difficult to get working although instructions given are straight forward. While



Iomega ScreenPlay Director

some of the video and audio internet streams are easily accessible through the player, any advanced options cannot be setup on the player. You need to register on the Iomega site, log into it, and then use a pesky Flash powered interface to get things going. It could have been a much simpler ordeal is all we're saying.

WD TV Mini

For those looking at cheaper alternatives to full-fledged HD



WD TV Mini

players, there's always the WD TV Mini to ponder about. With a product size that's no larger than three small slices of bread placed one on top of another, it's capable of playing most commonly used formats. There is no HDMI connectivity but you have component and composite connects which should be fine for most TVs. It does upscale to 1080p which means you can use it to play standard DVD quality

rips. Anything more, typically around 720p resolutions cannot be processed. Some formats can run at higher resolutions than some others. Although it might seem like a low power device, it can power standard 2.5-inch portable hard drives just fine.

The menus are designed to be a little from other the WD players. It's simpler and quicker to operate due to lacking features. Videos are also able to

be fast forwarded and skipped much quicker because of this. There is a visible drop in video quality that is magnified on a large 46-inch TV like ours. The WD TV and Live and all other players rendered standard definition much better. The resolution and performance drop also can be seen in the photos as well. With the reduced

features, the settings menu isn't subdivided into many subsections, so you scroll through one long list of parameters.

If you need something very compact for a CRT TV, and that can be hidden away behind it, this might be it. Keep in mind, remote control range isn't great.

Amkette Flash TV

The Amkette Flash TV player is very similar to the WD Mini. Just when we thought things couldn't get smaller, the Amkette goes one step further. It's the smallest player in this test. It connects to television sets in the same way as the WD Mini. This too comes



Amkette Flash TV

with a single USB slot but also a card reader for SD/MMC cards.

The remote control is slim, runs off a button cell battery; range is decent. For the somewhat simple feature set, the remote seems overkill. Buttons are really small but there are many of them. The interface feels basic but it's difficult to get lost. For example, the player starts into a display showing only the drive and the settings option.

For a compact basic player, the video quality is a lot better than the WD Mini although the Amkette refuses to play many more formats. Fast forwarding and skipping across the video isn't as fast as the WD Mini either. It comes with a text reader so you can read

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